

Meiji Japan Main Note

Tokugawa Shogunate, c. 1600 to 1868

Around 1600s to mid 1800s -> although Japan was ruled by emperor -> power lay in the hands of the Tokugawa Shogunate.

Under the Shogunate's Rule -> Japan was an [agrarian](# "one where the majority of economic activities revolves around cultivation of crops") society -> organized in a strict hierarchy.

During that time -> Japan was also quite isolated from the rest of the world -> with very few foreigners allowed into the country.

Order of Precedency: Emperor -> Shogun: military leader of Japan -> Daimyo: powerful lords who owned large amounts of land or ruled over a particular area -> samurai: military class in pre-Meiji Japan -> Peasants -> Artisans -> Merchants.

Meiji Period, 1868 - 1912

throughout 1800s -> prior to Meiji period -> Japan had seen the powerful European nations taking advantage of China because of its political instability.

European powers -> forced China to sign unfair treaties -> which gave them access to and control over Chinese treaty ports.

Japan -> viewed these developments with concerns.

by 1850s -> Japan had itself encountered US technological might -> when ships from US navy -> sailed into Tokyo bay.

United States -> demanded Japan sign treaties which would give it more opportunities for trade.

-> Japan recognized that US was willing to use force to ensure signing of the treaties and gave in.

1868 -> Shogun lost his power and emperor Meiji took control of the government.

with this -> Meiji Period started.

-> was an era of modernization in Japan with major political, Economic, and Social changes that would set stage for eventual failure of democracy in Japan.

Under Meiji Japan, these following changes happened:

- *Economic Modernization
- Political Change
- Social Change

- [Education System](#)
 - [Japan and the World; 1868 - 1912](#)
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Challenges for Japan, 1912 - 1932

Meiji period ended -> 1912 -> death of emperor Meiji

New period between 1912 and 1926 -> Named Taisho -> After new emperor Yoshihito -> AKA emperor Taisho.

While Japan continued its political and economic modernization during Taisho era -> it wasn't as politically stable as it was in the early 1900s.

We will view the challenges as individual concepts;

- [Political Challenges in Japan's government](#)
 - [Economic Challenges in Japan](#)
 - [Tensions in Japanese Society](#)
 - [Impact of The Banking Crisis of 1927](#)
 - [Impact of Great Depression](#)
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Rise of Military Influence in the Government

civilian politicians -> losing trust of people despite holding a strong position within govt in 1920s.

military -> grew in prominence and popularity with its victories.

-> further strengthened the military which started to act on its own and disregarded the PM.

-> eventually military gained greater control of the government.

Individual Sub-branches for this topic:

[Discontent from the Military](#)

[London Naval Conference, 1930](#)

[Manchuria](#)